

Fight the Problem, Not Each Other

What conflict pattern do I bring into the marriage?

Print this alongside the module, or type into it — every box is a real form field.
The workbook records what you did. This sheet records what you learned.

1 · WATCH AND LISTEN

Take these one at a time. A note you write in your own words is worth more than a highlight you never reread.

Resolving Conflict

Session video on working a disagreement without making the marriage the battlefield.

Notes — and the timestamp you want to come back to

Navigating Conflict

How couples move from position-trading to shared problem-solving.

Notes — and the timestamp you want to come back to

How to Externalise a Conflict

Putting the problem on the table instead of across from you.

Notes — and the timestamp you want to come back to

Why Your Partner Is Not the Problem

Deep-dive audio on separating the person from the problem.

Notes — and the timestamp you want to come back to

When Good Marriage Advice Goes Wrong

Critical audio on where conflict advice misfires. Read against the module caution.

Notes — and the timestamp you want to come back to

When Marriage Tools Become Dangerous Weapons

Safety inversion: how a fair-fighting rule becomes a control tactic.

Notes — and the timestamp you want to come back to

2 · DECKS AND FIELD GRAPHICS

On this module: The Marriage Blueprint; Marital Conflict Blueprint; Engineering Us; Marriage Conflict Resolution Field Guide; Marriage Conflict and Teamwork Guide; Marriage Teamwork Guide.

What stood out — and what I would push back on

3 · READING NOTES

Each report is an optional study aid built from thematically related research. It reflects the source material, not ministry doctrine — read it against the module's caution.

Conflict Resolution and Partnership

*The third episode of *The Marriage Course* focuses on the inevitability of conflict in marriage and provides a framework for resolving disagreements through partnership rather than opposition.*

Executive briefing — best starting point.

What I take from this

From Clashing Oars to Gliding Boats

Popular media and modern culture often propagate a systemic fallacy: the idea that a "correct" relationship is one characterized by perpetual harmony.

Systems-flavoured treatment of the rowing metaphor.

What I take from this

Why Your Biggest Disagreements Might Be Your Secret Weapon

We have all been sold a cinematic lie: the myth of the "soulmate" with whom life is a seamless, friction-less glide. We're told that if we truly found the "right" person, our gears would mesh perfectly, and conflict would be a relic of the past.

Popular-article register — the headline overclaims; read against the caution.

What I take from this

12 questions

Answer from memory first, then check yourself against the module page. The score matters less than the last column: a question you missed shows you exactly which part of the module to reread.

1. According to the course, why is conflict described as 'inevitable' in marriage?

RIGHT

☐

MISSED

☐

2. What is the primary message conveyed by the rowing boat illustration used in Episode 3?

RIGHT

☐

MISSED

☐

3. Regarding the first principle, what does the research of John Gottman suggest about relationship stability?

RIGHT

☐

MISSED

☐

4. What is the core function of the '10 o'clock rule' discussed in the session?

RIGHT

☐

MISSED

☐

5. The course uses a 'sofa' image to explain how to focus on an issue. What does this metaphor imply?

RIGHT

☐

MISSED

☐

6. What does the course define as 'external processing' in the context of personality differences?

RIGHT

☐

MISSED

☐

7. Why does the course advise against 'bargaining' as a conflict resolution style?

RIGHT

☐

MISSED

☐

8. Which statement best reflects the course's teaching on the ability to change people in a marriage?

RIGHT

☐

MISSED

☐

9. How does the course distinguish between a 'request' and a 'demand' for change?

RIGHT

☐

MISSED

☐

10. According to the AI reviews (ChatGPT, Claude, etc.), what is the primary 'blind spot' in the course's conflict resolution framework?

RIGHT

☐

MISSED

☐

11. In Step 5 of the problem-solving process, what is the recommended approach to a chosen solution?

RIGHT

☐

MISSED

☐

12. How does Nicky Gumbel reframe the conflict between a 'saver' and a 'spender'?

RIGHT

☐

MISSED

☐

Score out of 12

The one I missed that matters most — and what I am going back to reread

5 • FLASHCARD DRILL

This module's deck holds 38 cards. Run it until you can answer without help, then note what still slips.

Cards marked known

Cards I still need to review

Before you close this module

Field action: Establish and use your pause-and-return rule

Finish line: Your rule is written down, every boundary was honored, any pause included a specific return time, and one moderate issue ended with a written next step and review date.

Study is not the assignment. The finish line is.